

Tucson Audubon Society

Purple Martin Nestbox Design

Greg Corman 01/21/23

Materials

Galvanized steel ductwork, plywood, 2x4 lumber, cellulose and rigid insulation, various fasteners, and elastomeric paint.

Rationale for design

I followed the requirements provided by TAS plus the following criteria.

Longevity: The outer shell is galvanized steel and is covered with reflective elastomeric paint. The paint is warranted for a decade and the steel shell will last many decades. Plywood, when protected from the elements, has a very long life.

Replicability: I used off-the-shelf materials for the shell and nest box. The construction requires only modest building skills and tools and all materials can be purchased from a local steel duct fabricator and hardware store. This design could be easily reproduced by a team of volunteers.

Easy Maintenance: The metal outer top lifts off easily after removing just four screws. The top of the box within lifts off and needs no fasteners. It will take just minutes to clean the unit.

Climate Control: The nest box is made of plywood which conducts heat poorly. It is surrounded by cellulose insulation which will provide substantial and long-term protection from the elements. The steel shell has air vent holes plus drain holes in the bottom in the off-chance of water getting in the entry hole. The nest box has drain and vent holes as well.

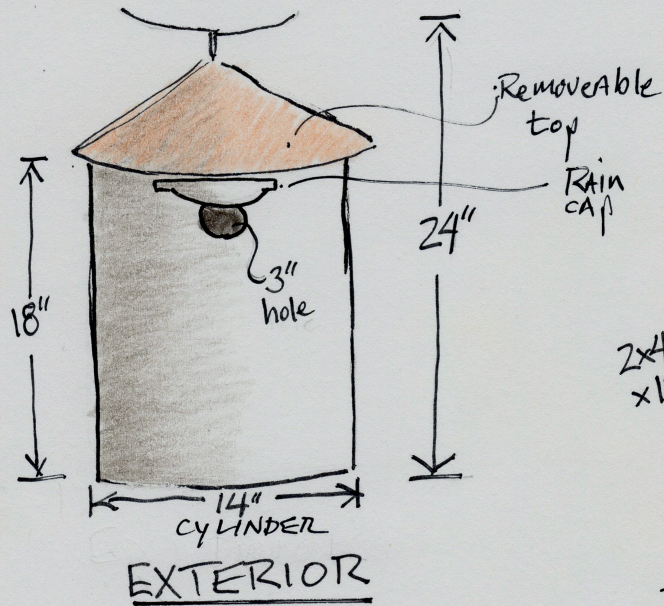
Artistry + Functionality: I tried to make the box both functional and attractive so it is an asset in the landscape to both birds and humans! The extended top decoration (optional) works as both a handle and as a perch for the martins.

Specifications and Installation

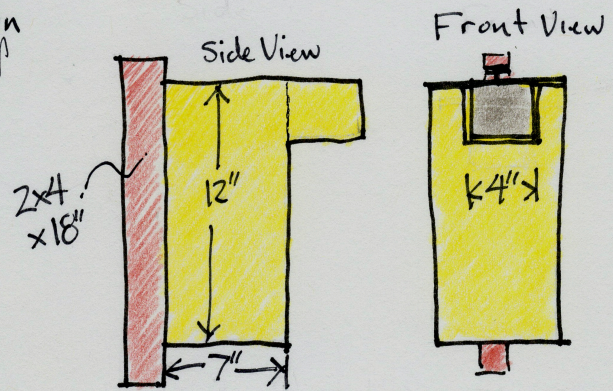
It is difficult to design a hanger without having specs for the poles, but a couple ideas are included below that put no stress on the box itself.

MARTIN HOUSE SPECS

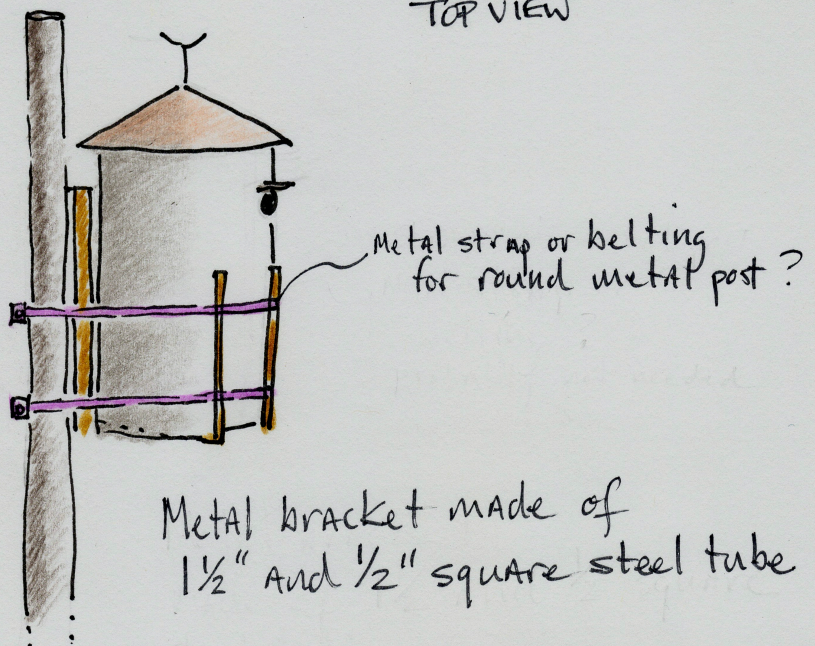
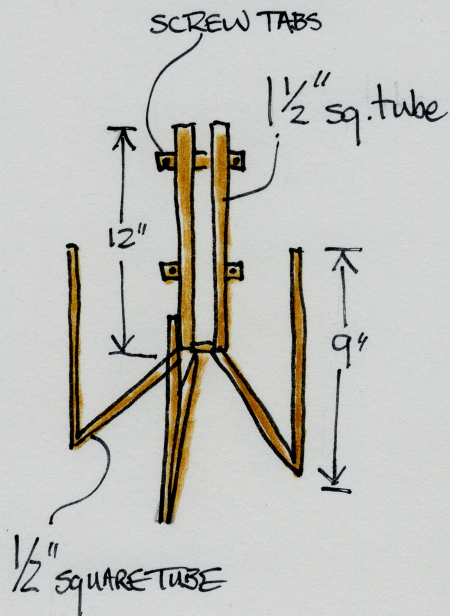
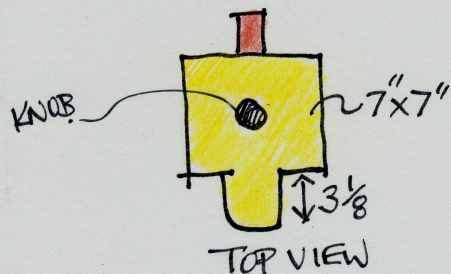
GREG CORMAN



1/2" PLYWOOD NEST BOX



INTERIOR DIMENSIONS = 6"x6"x11"



INSTALLATION